business continuity emergency planning policy

Version: 1.0 | Effective: | Review:

title: "Business Continuity Emergency Planning Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

Policy Title: Business Continuity & Emergency Planning Effective Date: [Insert Date] Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually] Version: 1.0 Applies to: All staff, contractors, volunteers, and residents at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to safeguarding the health, safety, and wellbeing of residents, staff, and visitors during emergencies and ensuring continuity of essential care services. We aim to: • Minimise risks and disruption caused by emergencies. • Maintain safe and effective care delivery during incidents. • Comply with the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014, CQC Fundamental Standards, and local authority requirements. • Foster a culture of preparedness, resilience, and rapid recovery.

2. Purpose This policy sets out the framework for: • Identifying potential risks and emergencies. • Maintaining business continuity during disruption. • Responding effectively to incidents. • Protecting residents, staff, and visitors during emergencies. • Ensuring clear communication, roles, and responsibilities.

3. Scope This policy applies to: • All staff, agency workers, and volunteers. • Residents and visitors during an emergency. • All operational areas of [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], including care delivery, administration, and facilities.

4. Roles and Responsibilities Registered Manager (Incident Lead): • Has overall responsibility for business continuity and emergency planning. • Maintains and reviews the Business Continuity Plan (BCP). • Liaises with local authorities, emergency services, and commissioners. • Ensures staff receive training in emergency procedures. Senior Staff / Deputies: • Lead the response if the Registered Manager is unavailable. • Coordinate staff, residents, and resources during emergencies. • Ensure incident records and reports are completed. All Staff: • Familiarise themselves with emergency plans and procedures. • Follow instructions during incidents. • Report risks, hazards, or potential threats immediately.

5. Risk Identification and Planning Potential risks include (but are not limited to): • Fire and Evacuation • Severe Weather (floods, snow, storms, heatwaves) • Loss of Utilities (electricity, gas, water, heating) • Infectious Disease Outbreaks (e.g., flu, COVID-19, norovirus) • Staff Shortages • IT or Communications Failure • Security Threats / Intruders Risk assessments will be carried out regularly, and contingency plans developed for each risk.

6. Business Continuity Measures • Critical Services Identified – e.g., resident care, medication management, safeguarding. • Alternative Arrangements – backup suppliers, temporary

staffing, manual record keeping. • Emergency Contacts – up-to-date list of key contacts (staff, suppliers, emergency services). • Relocation Plan – arrangements with local services or other care providers if evacuation or relocation is necessary.

7. Emergency Response Procedures In the event of an emergency: • Immediate Action – ensure resident and staff safety. • Raise Alarm / Notify – contact emergency services if required. • Activate Plan – follow the relevant emergency protocol. • Communication – keep staff, residents, families, and authorities informed. • Maintain Care – prioritise essential care tasks for residents. • Record Keeping – document all actions, decisions, and communications.

8. Training and Testing • All staff receive training on emergency procedures at induction and through refresher sessions. • Fire drills and other emergency exercises conducted at least twice per year. • Business continuity plans tested periodically through desktop or live exercises. • Lessons learned incorporated into revised plans.

9. Recovery and Review • Post-incident reviews carried out to identify lessons learned. • Recovery plans implemented to restore full service as quickly as possible. • Reports shared with relevant authorities (CQC, commissioners, local authority) if required. • Plans updated following incidents, audits, or annual reviews.

10. References • Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014 • CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 17 (Good Governance) • Civil Contingencies Act 2004 • NHS England Emergency Preparedness, Resilience and Response (EPRR) Framework • Local Authority Emergency Planning Guidance

11. Related Policies • Fire Safety Policy • Infection Prevention & Control Policy • Health & Safety Policy • Quality Assurance & Audit Policy • Safeguarding Adults Policy • Record Keeping / Confidentiality / GDPR Policy

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